OAKLAND ARTCC

ATCT Policies and Procedures - CPS-004

Version 1.2

Effective 09/04/2025

1. Airport Control Procedures

1.1. Real World Periods of Operation

1.1.1. For purposes of VATSIM, air traffic control facilities will not be required to conform to real world hours of operation

1.1.2. Controllers have discretion as to whether they simulate a facility's real world hours of operation or not.

1.2. Restriction on Operations

1.2.1. No real world published restrictions, such as noise abatement procedures, aircraft class restrictions, or restrictions on type of operations will be applicable, unless they are specifically included in the facilities SOP.

1.2.2. To ensure orderly traffic flow, controllers operating a TWR position may deny requests for training operations including touch and goes and practice instrument approaches to any aircraft. Controllers are encouraged to provide these services when able, however if they are unable controllers should provide suggestions for alternate training locations in the nearby area.

1.3. Tower Airspace Management

1.3.1. Unless otherwise noted in the facility SOP, the TWR position shall own airspace 5 miles in radius from the center of the field, from surface to 2500' above field elevation.

1.3.2. Certain towers will be given authority to use radar procedures to separate traffic; this authorization will be provided in the facility SOP.

1.4. Unmanned ATCT Positions

1.4.1. When a TWR position is unmanned, the overlying approach sector will assume tower management responsibility.

1.4.2. When a TWR lies on the border of multiple approach or center sectors, the jurisdiction will be noted in the applicable LOA.

1.5. Runway Selection

1.5.1. Unless otherwise stated in the facility SOP, runway selection is based on the prescribed procedures in FAA Order 7110.65 Section 5 Runway Selection.

1.6. Preferred Departure Routes

1.6.1. Pilots of IFR aircraft filing a flight plan without a SID, or with an inappropriate SID for the active runway plan and/or route, time of day, or aircraft class or equipment, shall be asked if they can accept the appropriate SID or departure procedure.

1.6.2. If the pilot declines to accept the clearance with the appropriate procedure, or indicates they do not have charts or proper navdata, then the route shall be assigned via “NO SID” procedures listed in the SOP. If no such procedure exists, appropriate departure instructions shall be coordinated with the overlying sector.

1.6.2.1. If an overlying sector is not online, the pilot may be cleared “via” their first fix, or “as filed”.

1.7. Pre-Departure Clearances

1.7.1. Controllers may only issue a Pre-Departure Clearance at these authorized airports:

1.7.1.1. KSFO – San Francisco International Airport

1.7.1.2. KOAK – Oakland International Airport

1.7.1.3. KSJC – Norman Y Mineta San Jose International Airport

1.7.1.4. KSMF – Sacramento International Airport

1.7.1.5. KRNO – Reno/Tahoe International Airport

1.8. Voice ATIS

1.8.1. A manually recorded voice ATIS shall be created using vATIS for airports not authorized for D-ATIS use.

1.8.2. Ground (GND) controllers who do not have a Tower (TWR) or higher-rated controller above them may create a D-ATIS/ ATIS. When a controller above them signs on, it is their discretion to allow GND to create and manage the D-ATIS/ ATIS.

1.9. Digital ATIS use (D-ATIS)

1.9.1. A D-ATIS may only be created at these authorized airports:

1.9.1.1. KSFO – San Francisco International Airport

1.9.1.2. KOAK – Oakland International Airport

1.9.1.3. KSJC – Norman Y Mineta San Jose International Airport

1.9.1.4. KSMF – Sacramento International Airport

1.9.1.5. KRNO – Reno/Tahoe International Airport

1.9.1.6. KSUU – Travis Air Force Base

1.10. Tower Coordination and Departure Releases

1.10.1. TWR shall not use radar procedures unless otherwise stated in the facility SOP.

1.10.2. TWR shall instruct departing aircraft to contact departure as soon as practical.

1.10.3. At the request of the departure controller, as specified by facility SOP and/or LOA, or as needed under a traffic management initiative, the tower shall use “Verbal Release Procedures”.

1.10.4. Verbal Release Procedures are as follows:

1.10.4.1. TWR shall obtain a release for each IFR departure by communicating the callsign, route or SID, and runway to the departure controller.

1.10.4.2. No aircraft may depart until the release is obtained from the departure controller.

1.10.4.3. TWR must ensure aircraft depart within three (3) minutes of obtaining a release, unless otherwise specified by facility SOP or LOA. If a timed release is in use, the aircraft must be airborne within a window from 2 minutes prior and 1 minute after the assigned time, in accordance with 7110.65 4-3-4 (e).

1.11. Rolling Calls

1.11.1. Rolling calls shall be used when an overlying radar facility is online unless otherwise coordinated, for aircraft that do not require a call for release.

1.11.2. Rolling calls are accomplished through either EFSTS or the Rundown List, as specified in the facility SOP.

1.12. EFSTS

1.12.1. Definitions:

1.12.1.1. The *Electronic Flight Strip Transfer System* is an automated process where Flight Progress Strips are printed with a bar code and can be scanned to print out at another flight strip printer

1.12.1.2. *Pre-Scan* is the process of scanning a barcode before scanning a strip to print at another Flight Strip printer with additional Information

1.12.2. When EFSTS Procedures are in use, The Drag and Drop function will be used when a takeoff clearance is issued to the appropriate Departure Control Bay.

1.12.3. Existing Strip marking will be used in place of Pre-Scan codes.

1.12.4. Advise the departure controller if an already transferred departure is unable to depart.

1.12.5. EFSTS Procedures must only be used at the following airports

1.12.5.1. KSFO – San Francisco International Airport

1.12.5.2. KOAK – Oakland International Airport

1.12.5.3. KSJC – Norman Y Mineta San Jose International Airport

1.13. Rundown List

1.13.1. Rundown lists should be utilized in lieu of verbal coordination for releases to the maximum extent possible.

1.13.2. When operating at a Class C facility underlying a TRACON/RAPCON, the rundown list is used for all IFR departures and all VFR jet departures, unless otherwise specified in local SOP.

1.13.3. When operating at a Class D facility underlying a TRACON/RAPCON, the rundown list is used for all IFR departures, unless otherwise specified in local SOP.

1.13.4. Towers Must:

1.13.4.1. Enter the aircraft in the appropriate list within 3 minutes of departure

1.13.4.2. Enter Scratchpad information into the rundown list message in accordance with local SOP

1.13.4.3. Consider aircraft released when TRACON steadies the flash

1.13.4.4. Call the TRACON for release if the TRACON has not steadied the flash within 3 minutes

1.13.4.5. Depart IFR aircraft in the order they are run-down unless verbally coordinated

2. Transponder Procedures

2.1. Code Assignment Procedures

2.1.1. Discrete beacon codes shall be assigned by the ATCT in accordance with the facility SOP, as applicable.

2.1.2. All aircraft that are assigned a beacon code within ZOA airspace shall be assigned a code utilizing the automatic code assignment feature of their radar software.

2.1.3. ATC shall utilize the following special code assignment procedures

2.1.3.1. 1200 for VFR aircraft not under flight following

2.1.3.2. 1277 for VFR on an active search and rescue mission

2.1.3.3. 4000 for military aircraft conducting operations with military special use airspace or operating VFR

2.1.3.4. 7500 for hijacked aircraft is not authorized per VATSIM policy

2.1.3.5. 7600-7677 for radio failure shall not be used, per VATSIM policy.

2.1.3.6. 7700-7776 for emergencies

2.1.3.7. 7777 for military interception.

3. Special Aircraft

3.1. The following aircraft require special handling and coordination unless procedures are defined in local Standard Operating Procedures. The “performance consideration” for each aircraft is not required, but must be considered, given current traffic levels.

Aircraft	Performance Consideration	Reason
SF50	T - Turboprop	Slow climb/cruise performance
C510	T - Turboprop	Slow climb/cruise performance
E50P	T - Turboprop	Slow climb/cruise performance
E55P	T - Turboprop	Slow climb/cruise performance
DH8D	J - Jet	Capable of jet-like performance

4. Flight Progress Strips

4.1. Controllers shall use and maintain Flight Progress strips for departing aircraft in accordance with the format outlined in Appendix 1 and Appendix 2 of CPS-004.

4.2. Maintaining flight progress strips may be discontinued or modified based on the following provisions:

4.2.1. En route or Approach is providing top-down service to Terminal Facilities

4.2.2. Single controller operations at any Terminal Facility

4.2.3. EFSTS procedures must be adhered to at all times unless otherwise coordinated

4.2.4. At the discretion of any ZOA Staff Member or CIC

4.3. Maintaining flight progress strips for arriving aircraft is encouraged but not required.

4.4. Flight progress strips shall be started by the first controller an aircraft establishes radio communications with.

4.5. Aircraft that initiate communications with the wrong frequency may be issued the appropriate frequency for the pilot's requested function before creating a flight progress strip.

4.6. When using TDLS, Flight Progress Strips shall be started when the controller sends a clearance.

4.7. When Clearance Delivery is staffed, properly marked strips must be passed to ground control. Clearance must order the strips in the leftmost bay in the following order:

4.7.1. A (top) to Z (bottom)

4.7.2. Smallest number to largest number

4.8. When Ground control is staffed, properly marked strips must be passed to Local control. Ground must order strips in the leftmost bay in the following order:

4.8.1. Bottom (closest to runway) to Top (farthest from runway)

4.9. When operating at a Class B facility, the following procedures must be followed:

4.9.1. All IFR and VFR Aircraft must receive a Full Strip with the appropriate information filled in.

4.10. When operating at a Class C facility, the following procedures must be followed:

4.10.1. All IFR and VFR itinerant (departing) aircraft must receive a Full Strip with the appropriate information filled in

4.10.2. All VFR local aircraft or aircraft that do not request flight following may be given a Half strip with the appropriate information filled in

4.11. When operating at a Class D Facility simulated to have an operating FDIO, the following procedures must be followed:

4.11.1. All IFR aircraft must receive a Full Strip with the appropriate information filled in

4.11.2. All VFR Aircraft must receive a Half Strip with the appropriate information filled in

4.12. When operating at a Class D Facility simulated to be without an operating FDIO, the following procedures must be followed:

4.12.1. All IFR aircraft must receive a Full Strip with the appropriate information manually filled in with the correct departure information given by the overlying radar facility

4.12.2. All VFR Aircraft must receive a Half Strip with the appropriate information filled in

Appendix 1: Half Strips

1	4
2	5
3	6

Box 1: Aircraft Identifier / ATIS (optional)	Box 4: Departure Request/Arrival Direction
Box 2: Shorthand or ICAO aircraft Identifier	Box 5: Departure Runway Info
Box 3: Squawk code (Departures Only)	Box 6: Destination Airport code

Box 1: Aircraft Callsign, optionally followed by the ATIS has been received

Box 2: Aircraft Shorthand or ICAO Identifier. Short Hand Aircraft Identifiers can be found in Appendix 3 of this document

Box 3: Squawk code - issued for aircraft requesting flight following or all departures out of a Class C airport

Box 4: Enter the planned VFR pattern departure/Arrival Direction. Markings for VFR Pattern Departures can be found in Appendix 4 of this Document

If an airport has specific VFR departure procedures, refer to the SOP of the airport for further details on marking specific VFR departure procedures.

Ie. R for Right Dumbarton at PAO, O for Oracle departure at SQL

Box 5:

Aircraft on the proper Departure Procedure and proper runway, the box remains empty

Aircraft issued a proper Departure Procedure, but another parallel runway, enter an L or R in the departure runway box

Aircraft issued a proper Departure Procedure for the runway, but the runway is NOT standard for the airport configuration. Enter the FULL runway number in the departure runway Box

Box 6: When an aircraft is requesting flight following and has requested a specific destination, enter the destination ICAO airport ID

Appendix 2: Full Strips

<table>
<tr><td rowspan="3">1
2
3
4</td><td rowspan="3">2A</td><td>5</td><td rowspan="3">8
8A
8B</td><td rowspan="3">9
9A</td><td rowspan="3">9B
9C</td><td>10</td><td>11</td><td>12</td></tr>
<tr><td>6</td><td>13</td><td>14</td><td>15</td></tr>
<tr><td>7</td><td>16</td><td>17</td><td>18</td></tr>
</table>

Box 1 - 9C:	In accordance with 7110.65 2-3-4b
Box 10:	✔ When Clearance is Issued
Box 11:	ATIS received (optional)
Box 12:	Not Used
Box 13	Departure Runway Information
Box 14:	Departure Intersection
Box 15:	Crossing runway (Taxiway Letter)
Box 16:	TMU Release/Flow time for aircraft involved in Traffic Management initiatives
Box 17:	Actual Departure time or SYD for aircraft involved in Traffic Management initiatives
Box 18:	Not Used

Box 10: Aircraft gets issued a check mark when clearance is issued

Box 11: Aircraft has received the ATIS. Either the reported ATIS letter or a checkmark can be used. This field may be left blank for efficiency purposes as long as Ground Control has verified that the pilot has received the ATIS before handing off the pilot to Local Control

Box 13:

Aircraft on the proper SID and proper runway, the box remains empty.

Aircraft issued a proper SID, but another parallel runway, enter an L or R in the departure runway box

Aircraft issued a proper SID for the runway, but the runway is NOT standard for the airport configuration. Enter the FULL runway number in the departure runway Box

Box 14: If the aircraft is an intersection departure, enter the taxiway the aircraft will depart

Box 15: Enter the taxiway an aircraft will cross another active runway at to get to its planned departure runway when crossing will be completed with Local Control

Box 16: When flow control or an airport requires releases, enter the following:

EDCT/CFR/release time in the box with the format MM

If subject your discretion is issued, enter SYD

If the aircraft is released on initial coordination, enter an R for released

Box 17: When a release time is issued, enter the Actual Departure time of the aircraft in the format HHMM.

Appendix 3: Shorthand Aircraft Identifiers

Shorthand	Type Name	Type ICAO	Shorthand	Type Name	Type ICAO
(Blank)	Cessna/Skyhawk	C150-2/C172	AZ	Aztec	PA27
CRD	Cardinal	C177	K	Cherokee	P28A/P28B
SW	Sky Wagon	C180	^ [2]	Arrow	P28R
SL	Sky Lane	C182	TCOM	Twin Comanche	PA30
SA	Station Air	C206	NAV	Navajo	PA31
VAN	Caravan	C208	SARA	Saratoga	P32R
% [1]	Centurion	C210	SEN	Seneca	PA34
TC	Twin Cessna	C310/C340	TOM	Tomahawk	PA38
CHNC	Chancellor	C414	SEM	Seminole	PA44
GE	Golden Eagle	C421	MAL	Malibu	PA46/P46T
CQ	Conquest	C425/C441	CHY	Cheyenne	PAY1-4
CIT	Citation	All Varients	SR	Cirrus	SR20/SR22
CUT	Cutless RG	C72R	D*	Diamond Star	DA40
COL	Colombia	COL3/COL4	T*	Twin Star	DA42
SP	Sport	BE19	KAT	Katana	DV20
SE	Sierra	BE24	CT	Citabria	CH7A/CH7B
DEB	Debonair	BE33	DEC	Decathlon	BL8
BZ	Bonanza	BE35/BE36	VIK	Viking	BL17
KA	King Air	All Variants	$	Mooney	M20T/M20P
QA	Queen Air	All Variants	G	Grumman	AA1/AA5/GA7
BA	Baron	BE55/BE58	PIAG	Piaggio	P180
DK	Duke	BE60	PC	Palatus	PC12
DUCH	Duchess	BE76	KODI	Kodiak	K100/K900
CUB	Cub	J3/PA18	TRIN	Trinidad	TB20
PAC	Pacer	PA20/PA22	X	Experimental	EXPR
COM	Commanche	PA24	H	Helicopter	All Types

[1] *¢ symbol can be drawn when handwriting on a flight strip*
[2] *↑ symbol can be drawn when handwriting on a flight strip*

Appendix 4: VFR Pattern/Departure Markings

Marking	Definition
SO	Straight out departure
R45	Right 45 departure
L45	Left 45 departure
RC	Right crosswind departure
LC	Left crosswind departure
RD	Right downwind departure
LD	Left downwind departure
R270	Right 270 departure
L270	Left 270 departure
P/X [1]	Pattern Work/Terminate Pattern Work

[1] *◯ symbol can be drawn when handwriting on a flight strip, a slash (/) can be drawn through the ◯ symbol when terminating pattern work*